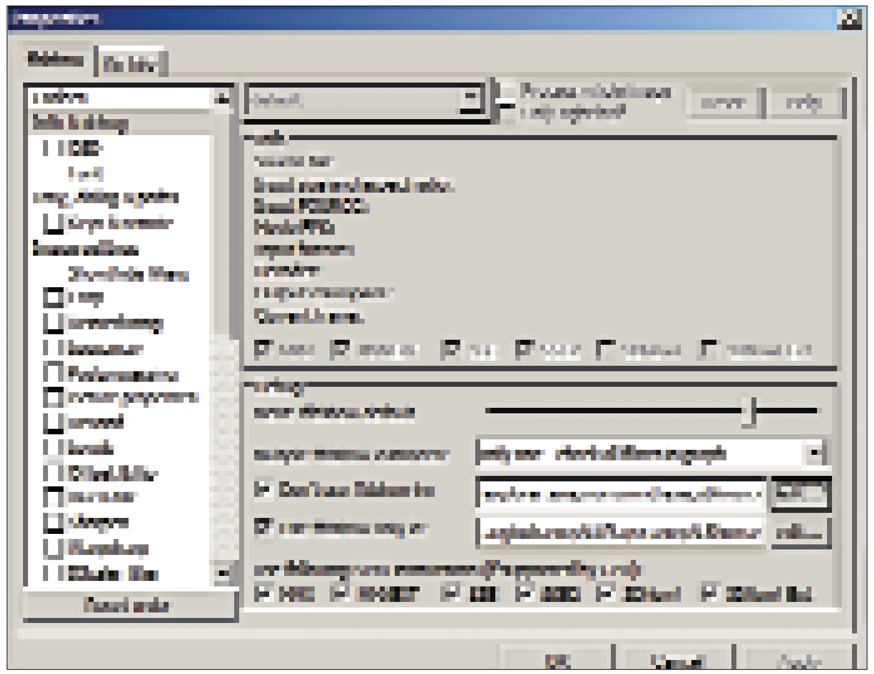
ffdshow Video Decoder. Choose and check the Picture properties box. Use the sliders for the Luminance gain (contrast) and Luminance offset (brightness) to change the brightness and contrast. Here, again, select the Only right half checkbox from the top of the window to get a preview of half the screen. Next, move the slider for the Saturation till you get a suitable result. When the settings are done, click OK.

Disabling ffdshow For Certain Applications

ffdshow can forcibly lock itself to certain applications and games. This can result in poor performance or other issues



ffdshow can have issues with some games—it can be disabled for them

while playing. One of the biggest problems was *The Elder Scrolls: Oblivion*; people had instability and performance issues. In such cases, it's a good idea to disable ffdshow. (*Oblivion* is one of several games that have now been added to the Ignore List of ffdshow in the releases that followed.)

Right-click on the playing video and select Filters > ffdshow Video Decoder. Click on Info & debug from the menu on the left. Here, check whether your application is already mentioned in the text bar next to Don't use ffdshow in. If it doesn't, click Edit and then Add to add your application. Browse to the location of the program and select the EXE of the application. Click Open. In the earlier menu, you can also use a similar procedure to mention which programs you want to use ffdshow *with* as well.

Saving And Loading Preset Settings

All the settings you've made can be saved through ffdshow for use at a later time, for example, on another computer. Start the ffdshow Video decoder configuration. Make sure you have all your settings done, then click on Image settings. Click on Save to file... to save the preset. Select a location and give a name to the preset. To load a preset, click on Read from file... To create a completely new preset from a saved preset, go to New > From file and select the file. To enable a preset, double-click on it.

ffdshow can also auto-load a preset depending on which format or codec you're using (or any other parameter). In the same Image Settings view, check the box that says Automatic preset loading. First click the preset you want to use, then click Preset autoload conditions. Here, select the parameters you want to check before enabling the preset. For example, if we want all XviD images to make use of a preset, check the On FOURCC match box, click the button next to it, and select XVID from the list. Click OK.

Using Subtitles

A few media players like Media Player Classic and VLC have support for displaying subtitles while playing movies. If you don't use Media Player Classic or VLC, then you might not be able to see subtitles in movies. ffdshow can enable subtitles in pretty much every media player.

Go to the ffdshow Video Decoder window by and check Subtitles. Click on the File radio button and click on ... to browse and point to the subtitle file, which may be where you downloaded it to, or in the same folder if it came along with subtitles. Select the position where you want the subtitles to be displayed by using the Horizontal and Vertical sliders. To change the style of the fonts, click on the Font item from the left. Set a suitable font, shadow, colour, etc. and click OK.

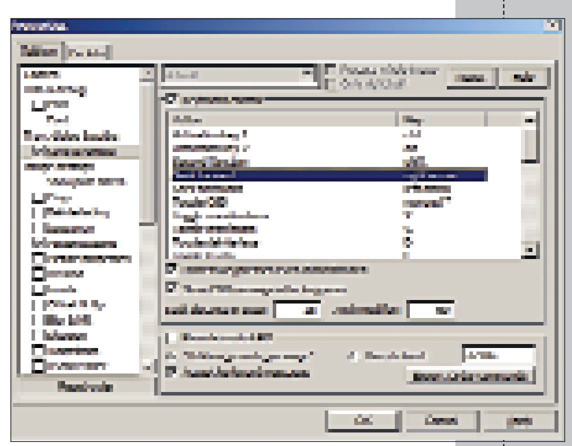
There are a few more advanced features. You can set a folder where all your subtitles are stored—just be sure to rename the subtitle filenames to match your video files. For example if your movie is called MovieTest1.avi, rename your subtitle file to MovieTest1.srt. Check the Heuristic search box; it can help in auto-detecting the subtitle file. If you don't mention a path, ffdshow will look for the subtitles in the same folder as the video file.

Capturing Images From A Video

ffdshow does a lot more than image enhancing—you can have screenshots taken at regular intervals during a movie. This can be enabled by right-clicking on the movie and clicking on Filters > ffdshow Video Decoder. Check the box for Grab. Select at what frequency you want the frames to be captured. Click on the button next to Path to select the location where the images should be dumped. Finally, set a suitable format and a quality setting. Click OK and start playing the movie to start the capturing. To disable the capturing, uncheck Grab.

Enabling And Using Keyboard Shortcuts For ffdshow Effects

Effects can enabled on the fly while playing videos using ffdshow. The shortcuts are assigned, but not enabled by default. To enable the shortcuts, start



Shortcuts are useful in enabling effects without accessing the menus

NiBiTor

Tightening a few nuts in your NVIDIA graphics card...

Rossi Fernandes

NiBiTor, or the NVIDIA BIOS Editor, does just that: it edits the BIOS of NVIDIA cards. (Download it from **www.softpedia.com/get/Tweak/Video-Tweak/NVIDIA-BIOS-Editor.shtml**).

Note: *Before we go through some of the important features of NiBiTor, we must warn you that modifying the BIOS is very risky; you could end up permanently damaging your card.*

Acquiring And Saving The BIOS

Before editing the BIOS, you need to first get it from the card. To do this, you first select the card you want to flash by going to Tools > Read BIOS > Select Device. Choose your card and click OK. Next, go to Tools > Read BIOS > Read into NiBiTor to have the firmware loaded into NiBiTor. Clicking on Read into file will save the ROM as a file. Choose a location and click Save. You can load this ROM by selecting File > Open ROM. You can load previously saved or downloaded firmware in the same manner.

Once all changes are done, you will need to save the BIOS by selecting File > Save BIOS. Choose a location and click Save.

Overclocking Functions

The overclocking tab shows the speeds of the card at different presets that the driver tells the card to run at. There are three main settings—3D, 2D, and Throttle. The speeds you set will be used instead of the default speeds for those profiles. Be sure your card isn't already running hot. Any drastic change in speed could physically damage your card. Enter suitable speeds in the Extra fields. For this, you could use overclocking tools such as Rivatuner (**www.guru3d.com/rivatuner/**) and PowerStrip (**www.entechtaiwan.com/util/ps.shtm**). When you use them, you'll get a good idea of how far you can overclock your card and monitor its idle and load temperatures.

Setting Fan Throttling

The controls for temperature levels and fan speeds can be found under the Temperature tab. We've spoken about profiles as well as speeds for the core on those profiles. NiBiTor can also change the fan speeds depending on the profile. On the right of the window, you

You can assign speeds for different profiles

The temperature monitor can be enabled on some cards that have it disabled by default

can find fan speeds for 3D, 2D, and Throttle. Enter the values as a percentage of the maximum speed of the fan. With this, your system can run quieter when there isn't heavy gaming going on. Again, you have to be careful not to run your fans too slowly, otherwise the GPU will begin to overheat. Depending on the type of card you use, you should see more options in the Temperature tab in NiBiTor.

Enabling / Disabling Temperature Monitoring

Temperature monitoring is a feature you'll find on most of the higher-end cards, but it might not always be enabled on entry-level cards. Modifying the BIOS could enable the feature. Click on the Temperatures tab and check the box that says Enable 6600GT temp monitor trick. On the other hand, if you don't want the temperature to be monitored (if you want any throttling feature to be disabled, for example), you can do it by checking Disable temp monitoring.

Setting Boot Display Settings

Every time you power up your machine, there are a few lines of text that appear at the top of the screen—information about your graphics card. NiBiTor lets you set your own custom text and colours—your name, for example, and other fun bits of text (you could make it look like you have an 8800 Ultra). With the BIOS loaded in NiBiTor, click on the Boot Settings tab. The OEM Signon tab has a preview of what the default text looks like. Adv. Signon has detailed information about the graphics card. Make any changes, or put your own text here. If you click on the drop-down for Boot Display mode, you can set a resolution, and you'll have coloured text instead of the standard grey using the drop-down menu for text colour. Click Apply when done.

NiBiTor only allows you to modify bits of the BIOS; it doesn't flash the card for you. Once you're done tweaking, you need to use a BIOS flashing tool such as NVFlash to flash the card. Put NVFlash on a floppy disk along with the BIOS file you edited. If you don't have a FDD, you can use a USB drive and get DOS running on it. A software called HP USB Boot Storage Format Tool can be used to format a USB drive with a bootable DOS image on it. (Get it at **http://files.extremeoverclocking.com/file.php?f=197**) Use a bootable DOS image to create a bootable DOS drive. Set the USB drive as the primary boot disk in your BIOS. Before writing the BIOS, make a backup on your drive of the existing one. This will come in handy if anything goes wrong during the flashing procedure.

Rescuing Cards

There's always a chance of ending up with undesirable results while playing with BIOSes; problems can also occur during the flashing procedure. Again, be extremely careful while modifying the card's BIOS, but if you do get it messed up, you'll have to use a backup PCI card to rescue your graphics card—restore the backup of the ROM that you took before flashing it.

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